Foxglove Utilities

Shared Laboratory Cost Allocation Methodology Guide | Public-facing use guide | Quillhaven Bureau policy in force 31 August 2026

Purpose and policy boundary

This guide supports finance, operations, reviewers, and publication staff using the blank fee-allocation model. It describes the decision boundary and the controls that keep incomplete or unsupported work out of publication.

Apply only the Quillhaven Bureau Shared Laboratory Cost Allocation Policy as in force on 31 August 2026. Use **METERED** where complete metered evidence exists. When metered evidence is incomplete for a cost pool, one documented proxy may be selected consistently for that whole pool: **EQUIPMENT_HOURS**, **STAFF_HOURS**, or **FLOOR_AREA**. Unsupported estimates are prohibited.

Defensible proxy judgment

A proxy is a documented judgment, not an estimate. Select the measure that best represents the shared resource consumed by the affected pool. Assess whether the measure is relevant to the resource, covers the same period, is complete enough to support a pool-wide decision, is applied consistently to every record in the pool, and is supported by traceable evidence. Record the evidence gap, selected treatment, rationale, evidence reference, owner, and approval status in Assumptions. Do not allocate when no support exists.

Scope and exclusions

The recognized scope codes are **CHARGEABLE**, **NON_PUBLIC_RESEARCH**, **CAPITAL**, **PENALTIES**, and **RECOVERED_ELSEWHERE**. Only CHARGEABLE activity is included in the allocation denominator. NON_PUBLIC_RESEARCH, CAPITAL, PENALTIES, and RECOVERED_ELSEWHERE are exclusions: they require a supporting note, receive no allocation, and do not change chargeable shares.

Using the blank model

The workbook tabs are Read_Me, Inputs, Allocation, Assumptions, Checks, and Publication_Import.

Entry and evidence

1. In **Inputs**, enter the cost-pool identifier, controlled methodology and effective date, total shared cost, one permitted basis code, expected minimum and maximum quantities, preparer/owner, and the reviewer release fields.
2. Enter every program/activity record with its cost-pool identifier, program code, scope code, observed usage quantity, and evidence reference. CHARGEABLE records missing either usage or evidence remain incomplete and cannot become READY.
3. For a proxy basis, complete one matching record in **Assumptions** and obtain APPROVED status. For an exclusion, give the reason in the program record's exclusion/evidence note.

Range exceptions and controls

Expected minimum and maximum values are review thresholds, not stop limits. A nonnegative corrected reading outside those bounds remains stored, is visibly flagged, and continues through the exact allocation formulas. Its pool remains HOLD until the out-of-range review field is Y. Missing usage, missing evidence, duplicate keys, invalid codes, incomplete proxy support, or a missing exclusion note also keep the affected work on HOLD.

Allocation preserves full calculation precision. **Checks** tests that exact CHARGEABLE shares total 1 within ±0.000001 and that exact allocated cost agrees with total pool cost within ±0.01 currency unit. Both tests use unrounded exact values. A HOLD status identifies unresolved input, evidence, review, sign-off, or control conditions. READY is formula-driven only after all applicable conditions pass; it is not a manual certification.

Review and release

Review the corrective action on Checks, resolve each HOLD condition, and record reviewer release sign-off, reviewer name, and review date in Inputs. Publication staff should release only rows with READY in the fixed import range. A READY row means the instrument's checks have passed; it does not replace the accountable review decision.

Publication import

Publication_Import is a flat, machine-parsed range. Its columns are fixed in this order and are formula-linked from the model; calculated values and flags are not rekeyed.

Field	Definition
Methodology_ID	Controlled methodology identifier from the cost-pool input.
Effective_Date	Controlled effective date, formatted as ISO yyyy-mm-dd.
Program_Code	Program identifier associated with the allocation record.
Allocation_Basis_Code	METERED or the permitted pool-level proxy code.
Exact_Allocation_Share	Full-precision eligible share; shown to six decimals without formula rounding.
Exact_Allocated_Cost	Pool cost multiplied by the unrounded exact share; shown to two decimals without formula rounding.
Public_Allocation_Share	Derived from exact share as a one-decimal percentage.
Public_Allocated_Cost	Derived from exact allocated cost and rounded to the nearest whole currency unit.
Assumption_Flag	Y when a documented proxy or assumption applies; N otherwise for a populated record.
Exclusion_Flag	Y for a recognized non-CHARGEABLE exclusion; N for CHARGEABLE.
Reviewer_Status	Formula output of HOLD or READY only.

Exact and public figures

Exact calculations are the reconciliation source. Exact shares display to six decimals and exact costs display to two decimals, while retaining full stored precision. Public shares are one-decimal percentages and public costs are nearest whole currency units. Rounded public figures can differ in aggregate, so they must never be used to assess the exact share or cost controls.

Status and flags

Flags use Y/N only. HOLD means publication is blocked pending correction, support, review, sign-off, or a passing control. READY means the formula-driven conditions are complete and the reviewer release fields are present. Preserve the field names, order, types, and status vocabulary when handing the range to publication staff.